

Halden Distribution Ltd. — vendor management procedure

Purpose: how external suppliers are engaged, given access, reviewed and held to account, so the business knows who its vendors are and what they can reach. **Owner:** IT (Muhammad Ibrahim Akmal) · **Approver:** Managing Director · **Review:** annually

Halden Distribution Ltd. is the fictional company used in this portfolio; ****every supplier named here is invented****. Market context: third-party involvement in breaches doubled to 30% (Verizon DBIR 2025, finding 3 in docs/plan/00-research-and-selection.md), which is why vendor records and contracts are part of the security work, not only the administrative work.

1. Scope

Applies to every supplier that provides IT hardware, software, connectivity, hosted services, backup, or an incident-response retainer. These are synthetic Halden suppliers:

Supplier (fictional)	Provides	Contract concern
Northwind Technology	Hardware and warranty	Warranty terms, response times
Contoso Connect	ISP / connectivity	Line SLA, escalation path
Fabrikam Firewall Systems	Firewall appliance and support	Support contract renewal date
Contoso Cloud Reseller	Microsoft 365 licensing	Seat count, renewal, price
Fabrikam Offsite Backup	Offsite backup repository	Data residency, recovery test evidence
Litware Security (MSP)	Incident-response retainer	Retainer scope, activation route
Tasman Print Services	Managed print lease	Consumables, break-fix response

2. The vendor register

Every supplier has a record in GLPI (Suppliers) linked to the assets it covers and carrying:

- Account number and support phone/portal.
- Contract start, end, **notice period**, cost and auto-renew flag.
- Named escalation contact and the provider's own response commitment.
- The **renewal alerts** at **90 days** and **30 days** before the notice date — no contract expires unnoticed again, which is exactly what happened to the firewall support contract.

3. Raising and tracking a vendor case

1. Raise it as a ticket **linked to the supplier record** (see the escalation matrix handoff template in p09-escalation-matrix.md).
1. Include the account number, serial or service reference, and the agreed support window.
2. Record the provider's reference number on the ticket; chase by the contract's response terms,

not by hoping.

1. Close only when the requester confirms the outcome, and note the resolution for the next review.

4. Vendor access to Halden systems

- Access is **time-bound**: created for a specific case, disabled when the case closes.
- Access is **MFA-protected** and where possible reaches only the specific system involved.
- All vendor sessions are **logged** and reviewed at the annual review.
- Vendors never receive a standing administrative account. This is the same least-privilege rule

as for staff (P1/P3).

5. Annual vendor review

At least once a year, review each supplier against:

- Security posture questions (do they hold our data, where, and with what controls? breach history?).
- Performance against the contract (response times, incidents, escalations).
- Value and cost (are we still using what we pay for — the licence right-sizing check in P9?).
- Continued need (is the service still required at all?).

6. Records and secrets

Supplier contacts, contract dates and support references are stored in the register and summarised in the BookStack "Vendors" shelf. ****Passwords, portal credentials and API keys are never stored in the wiki or this document**** — they live in the password manager with a shared collection for IT.

Status: designed for the lab; no contract, contact or renewal figure here has been measured or confirmed against a real supplier (there are none — the company and the vendors are fictional).